

London's World-Famous Monuments

10 Iconic Landmarks · Smart Skips · Central London

Every London monument has a hidden angle, a free viewpoint, or a nearby spot that's better than the paid attraction. This guide gives you the insider approach to all of them.

YOU SAVE: £267 vs guided tours

■ WHAT THIS GUIDE SAVES YOU

Retail price of this guide
£12.99

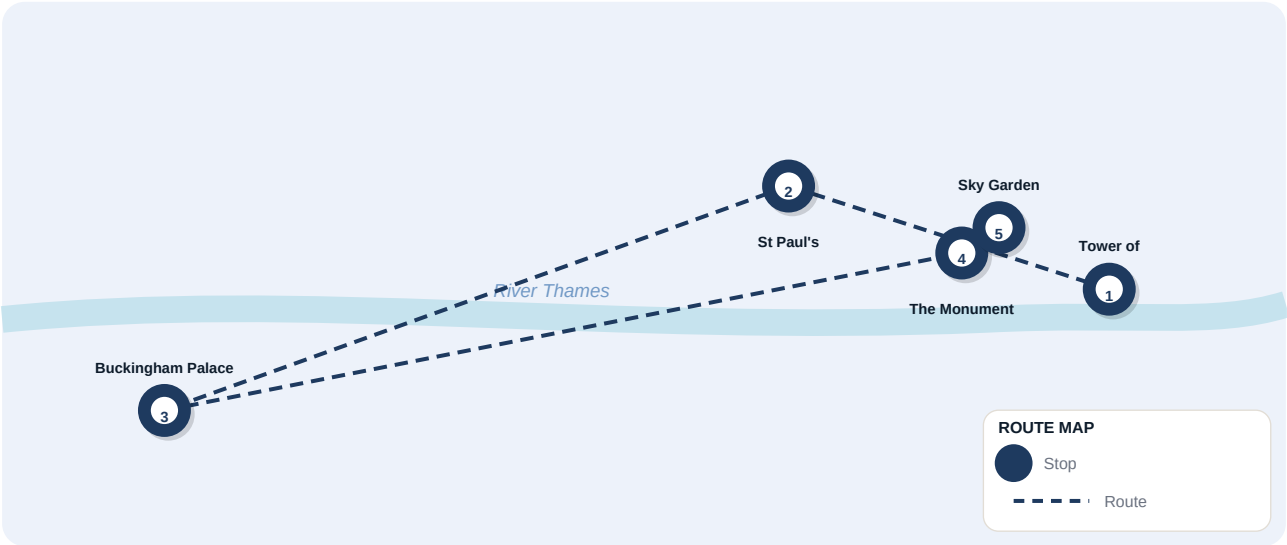
Equivalent guided tours
£280

YOUR SAVING
£267

ROUTE INFO

■ Start	Tower of London — Free Outer Walk (Tower Hill)
■ End	Sky Garden — Free 360° View (Fenchurch Street)
■ Duration	Smart Skips
■ Transport	From central London: Zone 1–2 daily cap £8.10 covers all stops
■ Total Cost	Guide: £12.99 · Most stops FREE · See individual stop costs

SCHEMATIC ROUTE MAP



PRO TIPS — READ BEFORE YOU GO

■ Best day	Tuesday–Thursday for fewer crowds at almost every location
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■ Saving	Pre-book anything with tickets — usually £2–4 discount per person
■ Offline map	Download Google Maps offline before leaving your hotel
■ Transport	Use Contactless card — automatic daily cap (Zone 1: £8.10, Zone 1-2: £10.10)
■ Members only	This guide is exclusive to London Lens lifetime subscribers

■ COMPLETE STOP GUIDE — LONDON'S WORLD-FAMOUS MONUMENTS

Follow stops 1→5 in order for the best walking route. Each card includes insider tips, savings info, and the cheapest transport option.

1



Tower of London — Free Outer Walk

Tower Hill · Tue–Sat 9am–5:30pm, Sun–Mon 10am–5:30pm

■ START HERE

HIDDEN TIP

The interior is magnificent but £30 per person. The free outer walk along Tower Hill gives stunning views of all the external towers. At 9:30am the Ceremony of the Keys rehearsal is sometimes visible from outside for free.

■ **SAVING**

Book online saves £4pp. Outer walk is completely free. Total saving: £34

■ **CHEAPEST TRANSPORT**

Tower Hill (2 min walk)
Cost: Zone 1

DO THIS:

- ✓ Free photo spots from Tower Hill
- ✓ Afternoon: Ceremony of the Keys booking (free — book at HM Tower)
- ✓ Walk down to the river beach at low tide
- Best: Early morning before crowds or golden hour

AVOID:

Paying £30 without pre-booking — always book online (saves £4)

★★★★★

Free outer / £30 inside

2



St Paul's Cathedral — Free Churchyard

City of London · Mon–Sat 8:30am–4:30pm · Evensong daily 5pm

■ 15 min walk

HIDDEN TIP

The Whispering Gallery is the paid highlight (£21). But the Cathedral churchyard is free and gives the best exterior views. At 5pm daily, evensong is completely free and genuinely extraordinary — you sit in the quire for free.

■ **SAVING**

Free evensong vs £21 entry. Daily saving: £21pp

■ **CHEAPEST TRANSPORT**

St Paul's (2 min walk)
Cost: Zone 1

DO THIS:

- ✓ 5pm Evensong — free entry, quire seats, full choir
- ✓ Churchyard photo at golden hour
- ✓ Walk down to Millennium Bridge for the classic Tate view
- Best: 5pm for free evensong — one of London's great experiences

AVOID:

Paying £21 before checking the free evensong option

★★★★★

Free outside / £21 inside

3



Buckingham Palace — Free Changing of the Guard

■ 25 min or tube

St James's · Check royal.gov.uk — usually 11am Mon/Wed/Fri/Sun

HIDDEN TIP

The Changing of the Guard is free but the crowds make it miserable if you arrive late. Arrive at 10:30am and stand on the Victoria Memorial — you're above the crowd and see everything. Alternatively watch from the Mall where you can see the full procession for 200 metres.

■ SAVING

Some 'tours' charge £15 to 'guide' you to free events. Pure saving: £15

■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Victoria (8 min walk) or St James's
Cost: Zone 1

DO THIS:

- ✓ Stand on Victoria Memorial for elevated free view
- ✓ Watch the procession down the Mall
- ✓ Check royal.gov.uk for ceremony schedule — not daily
- Best: 10:30am — 30 mins before the ceremony

AVOID:

Standing at the palace gates — worst view, most people

★★★★■

Free

4



The Monument — City of London

■ 20 min from Buckingham Palace

Monument · Daily 9:30am–6pm (last entry 5:30pm)

HIDDEN TIP

London's most overlooked viewpoint — 202 feet tall, designed by Wren after the 1666 Great Fire. The column is exactly 202 feet from the spot where the fire started. Climb 311 steps for a stunning low-level city view with no glass barriers. You get a certificate at the top.

■ SAVING

Sky Garden charges £0 but requires booking. The Monument's £6 buys an

■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Monument (1 min walk)
Cost: Zone 1

DO THIS:

- ✓ Climb all 311 steps for the certificate
- ✓ Photograph the City skyline with no glass
- ✓ Find the Latin inscription blaming Catholics for the Fire (later ...)
- Best: Mid-morning weekday — rarely busy

AVOID:

Arriving just before 5pm closing

★★★★★

£6 adults



Sky Garden — Free 360° View

■ 5 min from Monument

Fenchurch Street · Mon–Fri 10am–6pm, Sat–Sun 9am–9pm

HIDDEN TIP

The best FREE view in London. 35 floors up, 360° glass-enclosed garden with tropical plants. Completely free — you just need to book online in advance at skygarden.london. The viewing platforms on floors 35, 36 and 37 are extraordinary.

■ SAVING

The Shard charges £33 for a worse view.
Saving: £33 per person

■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Monument (3 min walk)
Cost: Zone 1

DO THIS:

- ✓ Book free tickets at skygarden.london (essential)
- ✓ Floor 36 viewing platform — most dramatic
- ✓ Early morning slots are quietest
- Best: Sunset (book the latest slot) for golden hour views

AVOID:

Trying to walk in without a booking — impossible

★★★★★

Free (pre-book)

QUICK REFERENCE CARD — CUT OUT OR SCREENSHOT

Summary of all stops for easy on-the-go reference.

#	Name	Area	Walk	Cost	Tube	Rating
1	Tower of London — Free...	Tower Hill	Start here	Free outer	Tower Hill (2 min	★★★★★
2	St Paul's Cathedral — ...	City of London	15 min walk	Free outsi	St Paul's (2 min w	★★★★★
3	Buckingham Palace — Fr...	St James's	25 min or tube	Free	Victoria (8 min wa	★★★★■
4	The Monument — City of...	Monument	20 min from Bu	£6 adults	Monument (1 min wa	★★★★★
5	Sky Garden — Free 360°...	Fenchurch Street	5 min from Mon	Free (pre-	Monument (3 min wa	★★★★★

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